

its scale. If Wikipedia is aiming to be the repository of all human knowledge, YouTube is a repository of human nature. If an alien race were to visit our planet, that's where it'll turn to understand the vagaries of the human race.

YouTube is standing proof that it's possible to have a video streaming service that delivers consistent performance across all platforms, anywhere and everywhere on this Earth. But only if you put in the effort to do that. Which cable companies aren't yet doing.

Fast Forward

What is the ideal television experience as we envision? What is the TV of our dreams? Is it even television? Probably not. TV was a major source of entertainment, primarily a source of video and great shows but now, 80 years later, it's none of those things. Our means of entertaining ourselves have evolved and moved well beyond the confines of the TV industry.

Seamless

What we would really love is a television that's nothing more than what it is – a large screen that we can experience our favourite content on – and should be capable of interfacing with whatever transmission devices we have. More than anything, we want our content available to us as and when we want it, with no hoops to jump through and no technical details to worry about (formats, protocols); it should be a seamless experience. We don't want our entertainment through only one device, we want it to be device agnostic, free.

Intelligent

The most effective “television” experience that we can envision is one that actually utilizes Big Data. Imagine a system that understands your preferences, maybe even your family's preferences; a system that learns your schedules, the TV shows and movies that you watch, the news that you're interested in, and pushes that content to your devices before you even ask for it. Imagine if you were to get recommendations from a close nit group of friends or if you could watch something that's trending on social media, be it a news snippet that shows NASA finding alien life or a video of a cat doing the



Don't judge him for watching Elysium and we won't judge you for watching Great Indian Laughter Challenge

Macarena or even just the latest episode of Top Gear.

Wouldn't you like to just come home from a long day and find everything that you probably want to watch already cut and dried, just waiting for you to hit the play button?

Personal

We want a television experience that's interactive and personal, where you can grab a screenshot and post it to twitter, or Hangout with friends while watching a football match or even watch The Great Indian Laughter Challenge (despite our best intentions, we cannot help but shudder at the prospect) and comment on the jokes on the spot. Imagine being able to simply subscribe to channels that you like, or even just shows that you like and not get flooded with random content.

Live news and sports do have their place, but there's nothing stopping anyone from providing coverage via a service like Twitch.tv or YouTube live streaming. Gamers have already adopted twitch as their livestream platform and it's more than obvious that the system works.

Should you smash that TV?

Television has held a soft spot in our hearts for a long time. Our entertainment

platforms have evolved and our lifestyles have changed. We're no longer tied down to a single source of information or entertainment and for whatever reason, TV still hasn't caught on to that fact. Most of us are not too young to remember a time without high-speed Internet and the rise of the smartphone, but there are those of us (generation Z a.k.a. the millennials) who aren't aware of a time without a smartphone and high-speed internet. We know that we don't want television, we know that cable and DTH is a pain and we know the joys of the internet.

Should you smash your TV? If it's old and decrepit and you're getting a replacement and it's not your only source of entertainment, sure, why not? But your TV itself isn't really to blame, it's the ecosystem surrounding it. Treat your TV just like you would any other large screen and bear in mind that it deserves more than a fist through the screen (if you don't mind a fractured wrist). But by all means, smash your DTH boxes and the accompanying antenna, chew threw your cable operator's cable (don't forget to livestream the event, we'd love to watch) and just refer to our guides for cutting the cord and smartening up your TV and you're all set.

Welcome to the modern age. **4**